Chapter 7

Ducks and People

SUMMARY. The ducks were at first people, and were washing themselves in the water. A man saw them and said to his people, "Let's go look at these things in the waterhole: maybe they're people." The others said, "No, those are animals, not people." But the man wanted to go near them, to go and eat them. So he and his people went into the midst of the ducks. The ducks bit them and pecked them and they all cried out and ran scattering. The ducks then again became people, and went on living.

SPEAKER. *N!ani |'Kun*

RECORDED. Tsumkwe, 2006

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yaa, yaa n|habite n|a
the, the ducks, now
hi hin he te tsi te hi sa o n|habite n|a hi !xare ge te hi !xare ce ge
they were the ones who came, and of those who are ducks, there are some kinds and then there are other kinds
te cete o Ju|'hoansi
and they were also Ju|'hoansi (people)
'mhm
mm-hmm
te ku ǁka ka g!u
and were washing themselves in the water
ku ǁka ka g!u te
and were washing themselves in the water and

ǁ'a haa n|e'esi, xare ha hin
so he alone, even this one
ku n!un ka ku khuin ha ku ooa si!a
was standing and this is what he was doing to them
ha, ha, ha se
he, he, he saw
n|habite ku djxa ka g!u
ducks swimming in the water
cete ku !oa si!a
again told them
"a-hoo, tcisa ke gea g!u n!ang m!a se"
"you there, let's look at these things that are in the waterhole"
te ko "a-hoo, ju ǁam khoeca hi to'a"
and said "you, maybe in fact those are people over there"
"a-an, |oa o ju, !ha hin to'a"
"uh-uh, they're not people, those are animals"
haa yaa
yes
"m taa ǂaeh g!a'ama
"we're going to go among them
haa yaa
yes
g|ae 'm"
go and eat them"
te tsi ǂaeh te ka si ku g!a'ama tsi, g!a'ama hi
and they went there and when they arrived they went into the midst of them
te yaa, yaa n|habite ku se si
and the, the ducks looked at them
okaa hi khoara
it was that most of them came(?)
te g!hooa si
and were sitting on them
he ku n!ai si te
and biting them and
ku ǁohm he ku n!ai te
then pecking them and biting them and
ku ǁohm te ku n!ai te si sin g!hoo, te ju g!xa sarakhoe te !aah u
pecking them and biting them and just sitting on them, and the people jumped apart scattering and ran off
si ce te g|ae o Ju|'hoansi
they again became people
te g|ae ku ǁxam
and went on living

ee
yes
tcisi wece n|a n!ausi ku koe n‡oahn
all these things the old people told us like this
te du
and did
ʼmhm
mm-hmm